

AIC-PINNACLE × OFFSYLLABUS

Community Engagement Guide

A simple explanation of the ecosystem, the opportunity, and how OffSyllabus can create a useful community experience.

The idea in one line

AIC-Pinnacle brings the startup ecosystem. OffSyllabus can design and activate experiences that make that ecosystem collaborate.

1. What is AIC-Pinnacle?

Think of AIC-Pinnacle as a startup ecosystem hub rather than simply a fund. It supports startups across stages and connects founders to incubation, acceleration, mentors, investors, industry, product support and other ecosystem resources.

Its public programs and activities include EMERGE, EVOLVE, ELEVATE, Idea Utsav, Startup India Seed Fund Scheme (SISFS) activities and MeitY TIDE 2.0-related support. Public information shows a mix of government-backed funding routes and external investor access; amounts mentioned publicly should not automatically be treated as proprietary AIC capital.

2. Who is already in the ecosystem?

Community group	What they bring	What they may need
Startup founders	Ideas, products, traction, business problems	Customers, capital, talent, expertise, partnerships
Industry experts	Domain knowledge, business context	Relevant startups, ideas, collaboration
Mentors	Guidance, pattern recognition, connections	Good-quality startups and useful interactions
Investors	Capital and investment perspective	Investment-ready opportunities
Agencies / service providers	Marketing, tech, legal, hiring and execution	Clients, partnerships, ecosystem access
Corporate / ecosystem partners	Business problems, pilots, distribution, credibility	Solutions, innovation partners, startup access

3. What needs to be understood before planning an event

- What AIC already offers through incubation, acceleration, funding and mentoring.
- How founders enter programs, cohorts and funding pathways.
- Which kinds of startups, sectors and stages are active in the ecosystem.
- Which events AIC already runs and what those events are designed to achieve.

- Which people are already connected to AIC: founders, experts, investors, agencies and industry partners.

4. Where OffSyllabus fits

AIC-Pinnacle	OffSyllabus
Startup founders	Community experience design
Mentors / experts	Young talent / student participation
Investors	Real-world challenges
Industry / corporate links	Event production and content
Incubation and acceleration programs	Post-event community follow-up

The point is not to replace AIC. The point is to use AIC's existing network and create formats that make the network more active, useful and collaborative.

5. What should “community engagement” mean?

Do not start with “What event can we host?” Start with “What useful interaction is missing from the existing community?”

A weak format

Speaker -> audience -> networking -> everyone leaves.

A stronger format

Problem -> people -> collaboration -> next action -> follow-up.

6. Three event directions

A. The Problem Room

Founders or industry partners bring real problems. Small mixed teams of founders, experts, agencies and young talent work on those problems and define a practical next step.

Best use: collaboration, pilot opportunities and mentor connections.

B. Reverse Demo Day

Instead of startups pitching investors, companies or ecosystem partners present real needs: technology gaps, growth problems, operational issues, customer needs or pilot opportunities. Startups respond with possible solutions.

Best use: startup-to-corporate conversations and pilot discussions.

C. AIC × OffSyllabus Real-World Challenge

An AIC startup posts a real business problem. OffSyllabus recruits young participants to work on it. The startup reviews the work and can offer feedback, exposure, project or internship opportunities.

Best use: projects, internships, hiring leads and startup-young talent collaboration.

7. Recommended first format: The Problem Room

This is the simplest format that clearly uses the strengths of both ecosystems without copying a normal pitch night or panel discussion.

8. Example event flow

Part	What happens
Arrival	Curated participants receive a quick “I can offer / I need” profile.
AIC context	5–10 minute introduction; no long keynote.
Problem pitches	5–8 real problems, around 3 minutes each.
Team formation	Participants choose problems and form mixed teams.
Solve	30–45 minutes to understand the problem and build a practical response.
Share	Each team presents what it would do next and who needs to be involved.
Commit	Participants record next steps: pilot, mentor call, investor conversation, internship or partnership.
Follow-up	OffSyllabus checks progress after 7 and 30 days.

9. Why this can work

- It uses the people AIC already has instead of rebuilding the network.
- It gives founders a reason to speak to experts and agencies beyond generic networking.
- It gives OffSyllabus participants a genuine real-world task instead of passive attendance.
- It creates measurable outputs such as pilots, mentor relationships, project work and partnerships.

10. How to make the event feel different

The differentiator should be the mechanism, not just the branding. Participants should have to make decisions, work in small groups and leave with a specific next action.

Design principles

- Curated room: invite people because of what they can contribute, not only because of their title.
- Low stage time: keep talks short and use the majority of the event for interaction.
- Real problems: use current business or ecosystem problems rather than hypothetical case studies.
- Cross-pollination: intentionally mix founders, experts, agencies and young participants.
- Visible next steps: every useful connection should end with an action.
- Follow-through: measure what happens 7 and 30 days later.

11. Example participant mix

A first edition can target roughly 45–65 highly relevant participants: 15–20 startup founders, 8–10 industry experts, 5–8 mentors, 5–8 agencies/service providers, 3–5 investors and 10–15 OffSyllabus young-community participants.

12. How OffSyllabus adds value

- Experience design: turn the ecosystem into a structured participant journey.
- Young talent: bring students and early-career participants into real business situations.
- Challenge format: convert startup needs into actionable experiences.
- Content: capture founder stories, problems, solutions and outcomes for future communication.
- Community follow-up: track what happened after the event rather than stopping at attendance.

13. What should be measured?

Attendance and social reach matter, but they should not be the main outcome. A stronger scorecard measures relationships and actions created by the event.

- Meaningful founder-to-expert connections
- Potential customer or pilot conversations
- Mentor relationships
- Investor follow-ups
- Startup-to-young-talent projects or internship opportunities
- Partnerships between startups, agencies and ecosystem partners

14. 30-day follow-up

The event should create a simple pipeline after the room closes: who met whom, what they agreed to do, whether it happened, and whether the relationship should continue. This can turn one event into an ongoing community program.

15. A simple positioning statement

Positioning

AIC-Pinnacle has the founders, experts, investors and industry ecosystem. OffSyllabus can activate that ecosystem through real-world, highly curated community experiences.

16. Research caveat

Public sources are enough to understand the broad AIC-Pinnacle ecosystem model, programs and public-facing funding routes, but they do not fully disclose confidential investment terms, internal selection scoring or exact proprietary capital deployed. Treat those items as not publicly established rather than making assumptions.

Key public sources: AIC-Pinnacle, Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), Startup India Seed Fund Scheme, and MeitY TIDE 2.0 materials. Use the latest public material when preparing any external presentation.